

VELVET PLANT

Gynura aurantiaca

This is the closest you can get to a plant that looks as if it's emitting ultraviolet light. The hairs on the leaves are so vivid, they appear to glow—it's almost supernatural! The abundance of foliage makes it a real talking point, creating a display that turns a dull windowsill into a strong point of interest.

“I will be a source of constant wonder.”

Help me thrive



POSITION

Place where it'll get good indirect light for a few hours a day, especially during winter. Needs a temperature of at least 55°F (13°C).



POTTING

Can be repotted in spring into a fairly rich loam-based potting mix, or replaced by propagated offsets if the original plant grows too leggy.



GROWTH RATE

This is fast growing so cut back or pinch out growing tips if it becomes too leggy. Given support, it can reach 6½ft (2m) high and 4ft (1.2m) wide.



CARE

Water freely during the growing season to keep the soil moist. Its roots are sensitive to rot, so never overwater or allow to sit in water.



I'll add some magic

A rare color in nature, my almost magically purple leaves evoke feelings of creativity, fascination, and wonder. Keep up the bright, indirect light; otherwise, my hue may fade, and try not to get my leaves wet as they scorch easily.



I can get hungry

I am an incredibly hungry plant during spring and summer. Please give me liquid fertilizer every one to two weeks during this growing season, to encourage me to produce more of my extraordinary foliage.



Touch me!

My common name is the velvet plant because I have many vibrant purple little hairs on my leaves, which give me a soft, velvety feel. Interact with nature by touching my soft leaves for even more sensory magic.